# Emotions and feelings

The same orange can awaken **joy** in one of us and **tension** in another, sometimes even both in one day.

Orange can awaken in us **the wish to create**, **warmth between people** and also **the pressure to be cheerful all the time**. There is no **single fixed effect**. It depends on **our body, experience, culture and situation**.

## Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

### Joy and playfulness

Orange can bring **a feeling of lightness** and **the wish to laugh**. The body relaxes and nothing is so serious at that moment.

#### And why?

It is linked with **the sun**, **citrus fruit** and **children on a playground**. Orange is a colour that **does not ask performance of us**, only **presence**. It has neither the sharpness of red nor the gravity of dark colours, and so it invites playfulness more easily.

Ask yourself

*“When did I last laugh sincerely?”*

### Enthusiasm and impatience

The wish to **start something right now**. **Energy on the move** that drives you. And when it tips over into **nervousness**, the feeling that **I must keep doing something** and must not stop.

#### And why?

Orange is close to red, only **gentler**. It encourages and sometimes **pushes**. It is no accident that it is used on vests and warning signs. It is a colour that says “here I am, something is happening”. In the body that can sound like pleasant liveliness, or like a compulsion never to stop.

If I asked you now

*“When did you last allow yourself to do nothing?”*



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### Tenderness and gratitude

A protective, kind feeling towards **people** and towards **a particular moment**. The wish to **touch**, **stroke**, let things be and be grateful for them.

#### And why?

Orange is **warm and soft**, without the sharpness of red. It recalls **lamplight**, **a warm blanket** and **a palm on the back**. The colour itself does not evoke tenderness or gratitude, but it can open a place for them.

Try asking yourself

*"What was I last grateful for?"*

### Shame and guilt

Right after **a pleasant experience** or **a pleasant thought** a voice sounds: "that's not proper", "you just don't do that". The wish to **hide**, **explain yourself** or **apologise**.

#### And why?

In tradition orange is linked with the area of **pleasure and the body**. With that comes our upbringing about what is "proper". The colour itself does not evoke shame; rather it **uncovers** it when it touches something we learned to keep on a short leash.

Ask yourself

*"Do I sometimes feel guilty about how I feel?"*

## Feelings and experience

Less immediate than emotions. They say more about how we feel in a situation, in the body and in relation to ourselves.

### The wish to create and try things

Orange can awaken **ideas** that run off in all directions and a feeling that **anything can be tried**.

#### And why?

The link with the **sacral chakra** and creativity is a modern view. Orange is the colour of **beginnings**, not of **perfection**.

A question for you

*"What would you like to try now and do not have the courage to?"*

### Sensuality and relationship to the body

It can bring **pleasure in the body**, an appetite for food, **touch**, beauty. Sometimes a quiet wish to be **at home in your body**.

#### And why?

This is not a magical property of the colour. Orange is the colour of **ripe fruit**, **warm skin** and **evening light**, and we link those impressions with enjoyment. How you read it is also influenced by what you have learned about what you may allow yourself.

Ask yourself

*"When do I feel at home in my body?"*



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### Sadness and nostalgia

It can evoke **a warming sadness**. A beauty that is already leaving. Memories of warm days that have passed.

#### And why?

**Autumn leaves** and **the golden hour**. Orange can hold a farewell so that it is not sharp.

Try asking yourself

*"What is drifting away from me and what do I fear?"*

### A feeling of closeness and openness

It can open a feeling of **closeness** and **openness**. The wish to be **among people**, to eat, chat, share.

#### And why?

It is linked with **a fire in the hearth** and **a shared meal**. Orange is the colour of **a table you sit around**.

A question for you

*"Can you open up?"*

## My orange is not the same as your orange

The colour itself **experiences nothing**. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the **experience** sticks to it. The colour then becomes a **shortcut**. One glimpse is enough and the body knows whether it can relax or should pull back. That is why **your own reaction** is the most important.

- **An orange at Christmas**
  For one person the scent of home and childhood, for another a compulsory sweet tradition she is tired of.
- **An orange vest**
  For one safety and visibility, for another work she hates.
- **The setting sun**
  Holiday and calm, or the end of the day when anxiety returns.
- **An orange wall**
  A cheerful room, or a room in which I never wanted to sleep.
- **Halloween and pumpkins**
  Playfulness and celebration, or fear of masks and darkness.

### Why does it attract me when I do not actually feel cheerful?

**Perhaps it does not express how you feel. Perhaps you are drawn to** what you are **missing**. You do not have to be cheerful for a colour you associate with cheerfulness to attract you. After a long period of worries orange can recall ordinary pleasure. Breakfast outdoors, laughter with no explanation, a warm evening or a touch where you do not have to sort anything out. Sometimes you are tired precisely of having lived only sensibly for a long time. And suddenly you like something simply because it is **beautiful, soft or a little bit mad**.



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### Why does it seem unpleasant to me, on the contrary?

A strong orange is **too loud** for you. It reminds you of **an old interior**, a school canteen or a setting where you did not feel well. If for a long time you **had to entertain others**, its cheerful look can remind you of a role you no longer want to play. An aversion to orange does not have to mean you reject joy or closeness. Perhaps you are only rejecting another **duty to be pleasant**. Try to tell apart whether you dislike all orange or only a certain form of it. A rust-coloured leaf can be beautiful even though you would not want a glaring orange wall even in a photograph.

### When to add it and when to take it away

Add it where it delights you and opens something pleasant. Take it away when you catch yourself **looking away from it**, everything feels too striking or you finally want fewer stimuli. Notice the changes. **Apricot does me good**, bright orange disturbs me. In winter it attracts me more than in the hot summer. In a painting I want it big, in clothes I do not feel good in it yet. These are your specific experiences. They do not have to fit into one answer **“I like orange”**.

If I asked you now

*“What does orange in a space evoke in you? Recall whether you have seen orange in a room somewhere at someone's place. How did you feel there?”*



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